

Tangent Vectors

1.1 Tangent Space

1.1.1 Geometric Tangent Vectors

Definition 1.1.1

If a is a point of $\mathbb{R}^n$, a map $w : C^\infty(\mathbb{R}^n) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is called a **derivation at a** if it is linear over $\mathbb{R}$ and satisfies the following product rule:

$$w(fg) = f(a)wg + g(a)wf.$$

Let $T_a\mathbb{R}^n$ denote the set of all derivations of $C^\infty(\mathbb{R}^n)$ at a . Clearly, $T_a\mathbb{R}^n$ is a vector space under the operations

$$(w_1 + w_2)f = w_1f + w_2f, \quad (cw)f = c(wf).$$

Proposition 1.1.2

Let $a \in \mathbb{R}^n$.

- (a) For each geometric tangent vector $v_a \in \mathbb{R}_a^n$, the map $D_v|_a : C^\infty(\mathbb{R}^n) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ defined by

$$D_v|_a f = D_v f(a) = \left. \frac{d}{dt} \right|_{t=0} f(a + tv).$$

is a derivation at a .

- (b) The map $v_a \mapsto D_v|_a$ is an isomorphism from $\mathbb{R}_a^n$ onto $T_a\mathbb{R}^n$.

1.1.2 Tangent Vectors on Manifolds

Definition 1.1.3

Let M be a smooth manifold with or without boundary, and let p be a point of M . A linear map $v : C^\infty(M) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is called a **derivation at p** if

it satisfies

$$v(fg) = f(p)vg + g(p)vf \quad \text{for all } f, g \in C^\infty(M). \quad (1.1)$$

The set of all derivations of $C^\infty(M)$ at p , denoted by T_pM , is a vector space called the **tangent space to M at p** . An element of T_pM is called a **tangent vector at p** .

Lemma 1.1.4 ► Properties of Tangent Vectors on Manifolds

Suppose M is a smooth manifold with or without boundary, $p \in M$, $v \in T_pM$, and $f, g \in C^\infty(M)$.

- (a) If f is a constant function, then $vf = 0$.
- (b) If $f(p) = g(p) = 0$, then $v(fg) = 0$.

1.2 The Differential of a Smooth Map

1.2.1 Differential on Euclidean Space

Lemma 1.2.1

Let $U \subseteq \mathbb{R}^m, V \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n$ are open sets. $f : U \rightarrow V$ is smooth. Take $a \in U$, define a map

$$\begin{aligned} (df)_a : T_aU &\rightarrow T_{f(a)}V \\ (df_a)(D_v^a) &\mapsto D_w^{f(a)}, \quad w = J_f(a)v \end{aligned}$$

Then for each $g \in C^\infty(V)$, we have

$$((df_a)(v))(g) = D_v^a(g \circ f)$$

Note.

$(df_a)(v)$ 对应的导子恰好是在点 $f(a)$ 处将 $g \in C^\infty(V)$ 映到 $D_v^a(g \circ f)$ 的导子.

Definition 1.2.2

If M and N are smooth manifolds with or without boundary and $F :$

$M \rightarrow N$ is a smooth map, for each $p \in M$ we define a map

$$dF_p : T_p M \rightarrow T_{F(p)} N,$$

called the **differential of F at p** . Given $v \in T_p M$, we let $dF_p(v)$ be the derivation at $F(p)$ that acts on $f \in C^\infty(N)$ by the rule

$$dF_p(v)(f) = v(f \circ F).$$

Proposition 1.2.3 ▶ Properties of Differentials

Let M , N , and P be smooth manifolds with or without boundary, let $F : M \rightarrow N$ and $G : N \rightarrow P$ be smooth maps, and let $p \in M$.

- (a) $dF_p : T_p M \rightarrow T_{F(p)} N$ is linear.
- (b) $d(G \circ F)_p = dG_{F(p)} \circ dF_p : T_p M \rightarrow T_{G \circ F(p)} P$.
- (c) $d(\text{Id}_M)_p = \text{Id}_{T_p M} : T_p M \rightarrow T_p M$.
- (d) If F is a **diffeomorphism**, then $dF_p : T_p M \rightarrow T_{F(p)} N$ is an isomorphism, and $(dF_p)^{-1} = d(F^{-1})_{F(p)}$.

1.3 Tangent Bundle

Definition 1.3.1

Given a smooth manifold M with or without boundary, we define the **tangent bundle of M** , denoted by TM , to be the disjoint union of the tangent spaces at all points of M :

$$TM = \bigsqcup_{p \in M} T_p M.$$

Remark.

- **projection map** $\pi : TM \rightarrow M$, $\pi(p, v) = p$.

Proposition 1.3.2

For any smooth n -manifold M , then tangent bundle TM has a natural topology and smooth structure that make it into a $2n$ -dimensional smooth manifold. With respect to this structure, the projection $\pi : TM \rightarrow M$ is smooth.

Proof. Given a chart (U, φ) for M , $\pi^{-1}(U) \subseteq TM$ is the set of all tangent vectors to M at all points of U . Define a map $\tilde{\varphi} : \pi^{-1}(U) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^{2n}$ by

$$\tilde{\varphi}\left(v^i \frac{\partial}{\partial x^i} \Big|_p\right) = (x^1(p), \dots, x^n(p), v^1, \dots, v^n)$$

□